

COMPREHENSIVE RESEARCH NOTES

Guru Bob's Encyclopedia of Indian Culture, Arts & Awards

A Complete Guide for Competitive Exams (UPSC, SSC, FTII)

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1. UNESCO INTANGIBLE CULTURAL HERITAGE ART FORMS IN INDIA

India has 16 elements inscribed on UNESCO's Representative List of Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity (as of 2025).

Complete List with States

S.No	Art Form	Year	State/Region
1	Kutiyattam, Sanskrit Theatre	2008	Kerala
2	Tradition of Vedic Chanting	2008	Pan-India
3	Ramlila, Traditional Performance of Ramayana	2008	Pan-India (North India)
4	Ramman, Religious Festival & Ritual Theatre	2009	Uttarakhand (Garhwal Himalayas)
5	Mudiyettu, Ritual Theatre & Dance Drama	2010	Kerala
6	Kalbelia Folk Songs & Dances	2010	Rajasthan
7	Chhau Dance	2010	West Bengal, Jharkhand, Odisha
8	Buddhist Chanting of Ladakh	2012	Ladakh (J&K)
9	Sankirtana, Ritual Singing, Drumming & Dancing	2013	Manipur
10	Traditional Brass & Copper Craft (Thatheras)	2014	Punjab (Jandiala Guru)
11	Yoga	2016	Pan-India
12	Nowruz (Persian New Year)	2016	Pan-India (Parsi Community)
13	Kumbh Mela	2017	Prayagraj, Haridwar, Nashik, Ujjain
14	Durga Puja in Kolkata	2021	West Bengal
15	Garba of Gujarat	2023	Gujarat
16	Deepavali (Diwali)	2025	Pan-India

Recent Inclusion (2025)

Deepavali - The Festival of Lights was inscribed on December 10, 2025, at the 20th Session of IGC at Red Fort, Delhi. India hosted the global event for the first time. India now has 16 elements on the list.

Upcoming Nominations

- **Henna** (Mehndi) - Rituals, aesthetic and social practices (2026 nomination)

2. RECENT ACADEMY AWARDS

WINNERS

98th Academy Awards (2026)

Major Winners

Category	Winner	Film
Best Picture	-	One Battle After Another
Best Actor	Michael B. Jordan	Sinners
Best Actress	Jessie Buckley	Hamnet
Best Supporting Actor	Sean Penn	One Battle After Another
Best Supporting Actress	Amy Madigan	Weapons
Best Director	Paul Thomas Anderson	One Battle After Another
Best Original Screenplay	Ryan Coogler	Sinners
Best Adapted Screenplay	Paul Thomas Anderson	One Battle After Another
Best Animated Film	-	KPop Demon Hunters
Best International Film	-	Sentimental Value (Norway)
Best Documentary Feature	-	Mr. Nobody Against Putin
Best Cinematography	Autumn Durald Arkapaw	Sinners
Best Original Score	Ludwig Göransson	Sinners
Best Original Song	"Golden"	KPop Demon Hunters
Best Visual Effects	Joe Letteri et al	Avatar: Fire and Ash
Best Production Design	Tamara Deverell & Shane Vieau	Frankenstein
Best Film Editing	Andy Jurgensen	One Battle After Another
Best Costume Design	Kate Hawley	Frankenstein

Category	Winner	Film
Best Makeup & Hairstyling	Mike Hill et al	Frankenstein
Best Sound	Gareth John et al	F1
Best Casting (First Ever)	Cassandra Kulukundis	One Battle After Another

Key Trivia - 98th Oscars

- **Sinners** received a record-breaking **16 nominations**
- **Autumn Durald Arkapaw** became the **first woman** to win Best Cinematography
- **First-ever Casting Award** given at the Oscars
- **Michael B. Jordan** won his first Oscar

97th Academy Awards (2025)

Category	Winner	Film
Best Picture	-	Anora
Best Actor	Adrien Brody	The Brutalist
Best Actress	Mikey Madison	Anora
Best Director	Sean Baker	Anora
Best Supporting Actor	Kieran Culkin	A Real Pain
Best Supporting Actress	Zoe Saldaña	Emilia Pérez
Best International Film	-	Emilia Pérez

India at the Oscars - Trivia

Indian Oscar Winners

1. **Bhanu Athaiya** - Best Costume Design, Gandhi (1983) - First Indian to win
2. **Satyajit Ray** - Academy Honorary Award (1992)
3. **A.R. Rahman** - Best Original Score & Best Original Song, Slumdog Millionaire (2009)
4. **Gulzar** - Best Original Song (Jai Ho), Slumdog Millionaire (2009)
5. **Resul Pookutty** - Best Sound Mixing, Slumdog Millionaire (2009)
6. **RRR** - Best Original Song (Naatu Naatu) (2023) - First Indian feature to win
7. **The Elephant Whisperers** - Best Documentary Short Film (2023)
8. **Period. End of a Sentence** - Best Documentary Short Subject (2019)

Indian Films Nominated for Best International Feature Film

1. Mother India (1957) - Lost by ONE vote to Nights of Cabiria
2. Salaam Bombay! (1988)
3. Lagaan (2001)

Most Oscar Nominations by Indians

- **A.R. Rahman** - 5 nominations (most by any Indian)
- **Ismail Merchant** - 4 nominations

3. RECENT CANNES FILM FESTIVAL WINNERS

79th Cannes Film Festival (2026)

Palme d'Or Winner

"Fjord" directed by **Cristian Mungiu** (Romania)

- Starring Sebastian Stan and Renate Reinsve
- About Romanian Evangelicals who move to Norway
- Mungiu's **second Palme d'Or** (first was for "4 Months, 3 Weeks and 2 Days" in 2007)
- **10th filmmaker** to win the Palme d'Or twice
- **Neon's 7th consecutive** Palme d'Or distribution

Complete Winners List

Award	Winner	Film
Palme d'Or	Cristian Mungiu	Fjord
Grand Prix	Andrey Zvyagintsev	Minotaur
Best Director (Tie)	Pawel Pawlikowski	Fatherland
Best Director (Tie)	Javier Ambrossi & Javier Calvo	The Black Ball
Best Actress (Tie)	Virginie Efira & Tao Okamoto	All of a Sudden
Best Actor (Tie)	Emmanuel Macchia & Valentin Campagne	Coward
Best Screenplay	Emmanuel Marre	A Man of His Time
Jury Prize	Valeska Grisebach	The Dreamed Adventure
Camera d'Or	Marie Clémentine Dusabejambo	Ben'Imana
Short Film Palme d'Or	Federico Luis	For the Opponents
Honorary Palme d'Or	Barbra Streisand	-

Jury

- **Chair:** Park Chan-wook (South Korea)
- **Members:** Nadine Labaki, Zoe Saldaña, Gael García Bernal, and others

Key Trivia

- Neon has distributed **7 consecutive Palme d'Or winners**
- **Barbra Streisand** received Honorary Palme d'Or (could not attend due to knee injury)
- **Park Chan-wook** joked: "I didn't want to award the Palme d'Or to any film because it's an award I myself have never gotten"

4. RECENT BOOKER PRIZE WINNERS

International Booker Prize 2026

Winner: "Taiwan Travelogue" by **Yáng Shuāng-zǐ**, translated by **Lin King**

- First book translated from **Taiwanese Mandarin** to win
- First **Taiwanese author** and **Taiwanese-American translator** to win
- 10th anniversary of the International Booker Prize
- Prize money: £50,000 (split equally between author and translator)

International Booker Prize 2025

Winner: "Heart Lamp" by **Banu Mushtaq**, translated by **Deepa Bhashti**

- First **collection of stories** to win the prize
- First **Kannada translation** to be nominated
- Mushtaq is the **second Indian author** to win (after Geetanjali Shree in 2022)
- Bhashti is the **first Indian translator** to win

Booker Prize 2025

Winner: "Flesh" by **David Szalay**

- First **Hungarian-British author** to win
- Szalay was previously shortlisted in 2016

Key Trivia

- **László Krasznahorkai** (2025 Nobel laureate) won International Booker in 2015
- He is the **fifth** International Booker-nominated author to win Nobel Prize

5. RECENT NOBEL PRIZE WINNERS

Nobel Prize 2025

Category	Winners	Achievement
Physiology or Medicine	Mary E. Brunkow, Fred Ramsdell, Shimon Sakaguchi	Discoveries concerning peripheral immune tolerance (regulatory T cells)
Physics	John Clarke, Michel H. Devoret, John M. Martinis	Macroscopic quantum mechanical tunnelling and energy quantisation in electric circuits
Chemistry	Susumu Kitagawa, Richard Robson, Omar M. Yaghi	Development of metal-organic frameworks (MOFs)
Literature	László Krasznahorkai	Compelling and visionary oeuvre that reaffirms the power of art
Peace	María Corina Machado	Promoting democratic rights for the people of Venezuela
Economics	Joel Mokyr, Philippe Aghion, Peter Howitt	Innovation-driven economic growth and creative destruction

Key Facts

- **László Krasznahorkai** - Hungarian novelist, known as "master of the apocalypse"
- **María Corina Machado** - Venezuelan politician fighting for democracy
- Nobel Prize announcements held **October 5-12, 2025**
- Awards ceremony on **December 10, 2025** (anniversary of Alfred Nobel's death)

6. OTT AWARDS & INCEPTION

History of OTT Awards in India

Inception

- **Filmfare OTT Awards** - First edition held on **December 19, 2020**
- Considered series released between August 2019 and July 2020
- Honours artistic and technical excellence in Hindi-language OTT programming

Major OTT Awards in India

1. Filmfare OTT Awards (2020-Present)

- **Inception:** December 2020
- **Categories:** Best Series, Best Actor/Actress (Series & Web Original Films), Technical Awards
- **2024 Edition:** Held November 28, 2024

2. OTTplay Awards (2022-Present)

- **Inception:** September 10, 2022
- **Theme:** "One Nation, One OTT Award"
- **2025 Edition:** Third edition, March 22, 2025
- **Categories:** 30+ categories across all Indian languages

3. Indian Telly Streaming Awards (ITSA) (2023-Present)

- **Inception:** 2023
- **2026 Edition:** Fourth edition, February 27, 2026
- **Owner:** ITV Group (Anil Wanvari)

4. Iconic Gold Streaming Awards (2026-Present)

- **Inception:** 2026 (extension of Iconic Gold Awards)
- **2026 Ceremony:** June 30, 2026, Mumbai
- **Jury:** Raaj Shaandilyaa, Seema Singh, Sidhant Sachdev, Saurabh Varma

Key Trivia

- India's OTT industry ranks among **world's most hotly contested streaming markets**
- **OTTplay Awards 2025** winners included Kajol, Jaideep Ahlawat, Jyotika
- **ITSA 2026** drew biggest turnout in its four-year history

7. TELEVISION HISTORY IN INDIA

Inception of Television in India

Timeline

Year	Milestone
September 15, 1959	Doordarshan launched as experimental transmission from Delhi
1961	School Television for Delhi students
1965	Regular daily transmission with news bulletin in Hindi
January 26, 1967	Krishi Darshan launched - longest-running TV show in India
October 2, 1972	Television extended to Mumbai (second city)
1973	Stations in Srinagar and Amritsar
1975	Stations in Calcutta, Madras, Lucknow (7 cities total)
August 1, 1975	SITE (Satellite Instructional Television Experiment) launched
April 1, 1976	Doordarshan separated from All India Radio
November 1982	Colour television introduced for Asian Games in Delhi
1982	INSAT-1A launched, enabling national networking
1984	Hum Log - First soap opera (1984-85)
1986	Malgudi Days - Landmark serial

First Televised Show in India

- **Krishi Darshan** (January 26, 1967) - Longest-running Indian TV program
- Focused on agricultural information for farmers

First News Bulletin

- **Pratima Puri** - First newsreader (1965)
- Daily news bulletin in Hindi started in 1965

Landmark Shows on Doordarshan

1. **Hum Log** (1984-85) - First soap opera
2. **Buniyaad** (1986-87) - Family drama
3. **Malgudi Days** (1986-88) - Based on R.K. Narayan's stories
4. **Ramayan** (1987-88) - Epic mythological
5. **Mahabharat** (1988-90) - Epic mythological
6. **Chandrakanta** (1994-96) - Fantasy adventure

Key Facts

- **Doordarshan** is India's state-owned public television broadcaster
- Started with **21 community television sets** and **40 km broadcast radius**
- **First colour telecast:** August 15, 1982 (PM Indira Gandhi's Independence Day speech)

8. ANIMATION IN INDIA

History of Indian Animation

Timeline

Year	Milestone
1912	The Growth of a Pea Plant by Dadasaheb Phalke - First time-lapse photography
1915	Agkadyanchi Mouj (Matchsticks' Fun) - Phalke's animated short
1934	The Pea Brothers - First Indian animated film released in theatres (Calcutta)
1934	On a Moonlit Night - First Indian animated film with soundtrack
1934	Jambu Kaka - Prabhat Film Company's animated short
1956	Clair Weeks (Disney animator) invited to establish first animation studio
1957	The Banyan Deer - First Indian animated film in colour
1974	Ek Anek Aur Ekta - Landmark educational animated short
1986	Ghayab Aaya - First Indian animated TV series
2008	Roadside Romeo - First Indian 3D animated film

Pioneers

- **Dadasaheb Phalke** - Father of Indian Cinema, pioneered animation
- **Gunamoy Banerjee** - Directed The Pea Brothers (1934)
- **Clair Weeks** - Disney animator who trained Indian animators
- **Ram Mohan** - Veteran animator, started at Films Division

Key Facts

- **Over 130 animated movies** produced in India since 1957
- **Ek Anek Aur Ekta** - Won National Film Award for Best Educational Film
- **Ghayab Aaya** - First Indian animated TV series (1986, Doordarshan)

9. INDIAN FILM HISTORY & TRIVIA

Landmark Movies

Early Cinema

1. **Raja Harishchandra** (1913) - First Indian feature film by Dadasaheb Phalke
2. **Alam Ara** (1931) - First Indian talkie
3. **Achhut Kanya** (1936) - First Indian film with social message
4. **Kismet** (1943) - First Indian film to run for 100+ weeks

Golden Era

1. **Mother India** (1957) - First Indian film nominated for Oscar
2. **Pyasa** (1957) - Guru Dutt's masterpiece
3. **Mughal-e-Azam** (1960) - Epic historical drama
4. **Pather Panchali** (1955) - Satyajit Ray's Apu Trilogy
5. **Sholay** (1975) - Most iconic Bollywood film

Modern Era

1. **Mr. India** (1987) - First Indian sci-fi film
2. **Lagaan** (2001) - Third Indian film nominated for Oscar
3. **Slumdog Millionaire** (2008) - 8 Oscars including Best Picture
4. **RRR** (2022) - First Indian feature to win Oscar (Naatu Naatu)

Trivia - Most Films to Get Oscars

Films with Most Oscar Wins (Indian Connection)

1. **Slumdog Millionaire** (2008) - 8 Oscars

2. **Gandhi** (1982) - 8 Oscars (Indian co-production)
3. **RRR** (2022) - 1 Oscar (Best Original Song)

Most Oscar Nominations by Indians

- **A.R. Rahman** - 5 nominations
- **Ismail Merchant** - 4 nominations

Trivia - Actors with Most National Film Awards

Most National Film Awards (Actors)

1. **Kamal Haasan** - 4 awards (most by any actor)
2. **Mohanlal** - 4 awards (including Dadasaheb Phalke Award)
3. **Mithun Chakraborty** - 3 awards
4. **Amitabh Bachchan** - 3 awards

Most National Film Awards (Actresses)

1. **Shabana Azmi** - 5 awards (most by any actress)
2. **Suhasini Mulay** - 3 awards
3. **Sharmila Tagore** - 3 awards

10. RECENT NATIONAL FILM AWARDS WINNERS

71st National Film Awards (2023 Films, Announced 2025)

Major Winners

Category	Winner(s)	Film
Best Feature Film	-	12th Fail
Best Actor	Shah Rukh Khan & Vikrant Massey	Jawan & 12th Fail
Best Actress	Rani Mukerji	Mrs. Chatterjee vs Norway
Best Director	Sudipto Sen	The Kerala Story
Dadasaheb Phalke Award	Mohanlal	-
Best Popular Film	-	Rocky Aur Rani Kii Prem Kahaani
Best Hindi Film	-	Kathal: A Jackfruit Mystery
Best Telugu Film	-	Bhagavanth Kesari
Best Tamil Film	-	Parking
Best Malayalam Film	-	Ullozhukku
Best Kannada Film	-	Kandeelu: The Ray of Hope
Best Gujarati Film	-	Vash

Technical Awards

- **Best Cinematography:** The Kerala Story
- **Best Sound Design:** Animal
- **Best Production Design:** 2018 - Everyone is a Hero

- **Best Choreography:** Vaibhavi Merchant (Rocky Aur Rani)
- **Best Action Direction:** Hanu-Man

Key Trivia

- **Shah Rukh Khan** won his **first National Award** after 30+ year career
- **Vikrant Massey** won his first National Award
- **Rani Mukerji** won her first National Award
- **Mohanlal** received Dadasaheb Phalke Award
- **12th Fail** emerged as Best Film

11. GROUP THEATRE MOVEMENTS IN INDIA

Overview

Group Theatre movement in India emerged in the 1930s-1940s as a reaction against the commercial theatre. It emphasized socially relevant themes and experimental techniques.

Key Features

- Collective ownership and decision-making
- Non-commercial, socially committed theatre
- Influence of European avant-garde movements
- Integration of folk traditions with modern techniques

Major Group Theatre Movements

1. Indian People's Theatre Association (IPTA)

- **Founded:** 1943
- **Focus:** Progressive, left-leaning theatre
- **Contributions:** Integrated folk forms with modern themes

2. Theatre Group (Mumbai)

- **Founded:** 1936
- **Key Figures:** Habib Tanvir, Ebrahim Alkazi
- **Contributions:** Experimental theatre, street plays

3. Madras Players

- **Founded:** 1954

- **Contributions:** English-language theatre in South India

4. Ninasam (Karnataka)

- **Founded:** 1950s
- **Key Figure:** T.P. Kailasam
- **Contributions:** Kannada theatre renaissance

Puppet Theatre in India

Tolpava Koothu (Leather Shadow Puppetry)

- **State:** Kerala
- **Meaning:** "The dance of leather puppets"
- **Language:** Tamil (Kamba Ramayana)
- **Duration:** 7-21 nights
- **Puppets:** Made from deerskin, 130+ figures needed
- **Performance Space:** Koothu Madam (permanent theatre in temple courtyards)
- **Audience:** Goddess Bhadrakali (primary audience)
- **Districts:** Palakkad, Thrissur, Malappuram

Other Puppet Forms

1. **Tholu Bommalata** - Andhra Pradesh (largest puppets, life-sized)
2. **Togalu Gombeyatta** - Karnataka
3. **Ravanachhaya** - Odisha (smallest, opaque puppets)
4. **Kathputli** - Rajasthan (string puppets)
5. **Pavakathakali** - Kerala (glove puppet version of Kathakali)

12. GI TAG - HISTORY & RECENT ART FORMS

History of GI Tag in India

Timeline

- **1999:** Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act passed
- **2003:** Act came into effect (September 15)
- **2004: Darjeeling Tea** - First GI tag in India
- **2024:** 603 registered GIs
- **2026:** Over 724 GI-tagged products registered

Key Facts

- **GI Registry:** Located in Chennai
- **Administered by:** DPIIT (Ministry of Commerce and Industry)
- **Validity:** 10 years, renewable
- **International basis:** TRIPS Agreement of WTO
- **Target:** 10,000 GI tags by 2030

Recent Art Forms with GI Tags (2024-2026)

2024-2025 Additions

Product	State	Category
Majuli Masks	Assam	Handicraft
Kaji Nemu	Assam	Agricultural
Bodo Traditional Textiles	Assam	Handicraft
Pithora Paintings	Gujarat	Handicraft
Bandarban Weaving	NE States	Handicraft
Boka Chaul	Assam	Agricultural
Lanjia Saura Painting	Odisha	Handicraft
Koraput Kala Jeera Rice	Odisha	Agricultural

2026 Additions

Product	State	Category
Karbi Anglong Handloom	Assam	Handicraft
Bihu Pepa	Assam	Musical Instrument
Assamese Bamboo Craft	Assam	Handicraft
Deuri Handloom	Assam	Handicraft
Sarinda (String Instrument)	Tripura	Musical Instrument
Tussar Silk and Sarees	Jharkhand	Textile
Kuchai Silk Saree	Jharkhand	Textile
Dokra Craft	Jharkhand	Metalcraft
Jadopatia Painting	Jharkhand	Folk/Tribal Art
Munda Jewellery	Jharkhand	Tribal Jewellery
Kesaria Kalakand	Jharkhand	Traditional Sweet

Famous GI-Tagged Products

1. **Darjeeling Tea** - First GI in India (2004)
2. **Kanchipuram Silk** - Tamil Nadu
3. **Mysore Silk** - Karnataka
4. **Pashmina** - J&K
5. **Banarasi Sari** - UP
6. **Tirupati Laddu** - Andhra Pradesh
7. **Hyderabad Haleem** - Telangana (first non-veg GI)
8. **Madhubani Painting** - Bihar
9. **Warli Painting** - Maharashtra
10. **Ajrakh** - Gujarat

GI Battles

- **Banglar Rasogolla** (West Bengal, 2017) vs **Odisha Rasagola** (Odisha, 2018)
- Both coexist
- **Basmati Rice** - 7 northern states (2016)

13. HINDI LITERATURE MOVEMENTS

(CHHAYAWAD)

Overview of Chhayawad

Chhayawad (Shadowism) refers to the era of mystical-romanticism in Hindi literature, spanning approximately **1918-1936**.

Four Pillars of Chhayawad

1. **Jaishankar Prasad** (1889-1937)
2. **Suryakant Tripathi 'Nirala'** (1896-1961)
3. **Sumitranandan Pant** (1900-1977)
4. **Mahadevi Varma** (1907-1987)

Characteristics

- Reaction against didacticism of Dwivedi era
- Blending of classical Indian heritage with Western sensibilities
- Themes: Love as spiritual force, reverence for nature, individual's quest for identity
- Aesthetic and romantic subject matter
- Emotional and personal expression

Major Works

Jaishankar Prasad

- **Kamayani** (1936) - Magnum opus, epic of human psyche
- **Lehar** (1923) - Collection of poems
- **Prem Pathik** (1914) - Narrative poem

Suryakant Tripathi 'Nirala'

- **Tulsidas** (1935) - Biography in verse
- **Anamika** (1939) - Notable for Ram Ki Shakti Puja and Saroj Smriti
- **Kukurmutta** - Prose work

Sumitranandan Pant

- **Veena** (1927) - Early work
- **Gunjan** (1932) - Dawn
- **Pallav** (1936) - Considered his masterpiece
- **Chidambara** (1951) - Later work

Mahadevi Varma

- **Yama** (1939) - Collection of poems
- **Deepshikha** (1942) - Torch
- **Neerja** (1933) - Lotus
- **Rashmi** (1932) - Ray of light

Historical Context

- Emerged during Indian independence movement
- Influence of Rabindranath Tagore (Nobel Prize 1913)
- Reaction against rigid rules of Dwivedi era
- Search for new poetic language in Khari Boli

14. INDIAN FOLK MUSIC

Overview

India has a rich tradition of folk music varying by region, community, and occasion.

Major Folk Music Traditions

North India

1. **Bhangra** - Punjab (harvest festival music)
2. **Lavani** - Maharashtra (ballad form)
3. **Dandiya** - Gujarat (stick dance music)
4. **Chappeli** - Uttarakhand
5. **Pandavani** - Chhattisgarh (storytelling)

South India

1. **Oppari** - Tamil Nadu (lamentation songs)
2. **Villu Pattu** - Tamil Nadu (bow song)
3. **Karadi Kathai** - Kerala (storytelling)
4. **Gaana** - Tamil Nadu (street music)

East India

1. **Baul** - Bengal (mystic minstrels)
2. **Lalon Geeti** - Bengal (Lalon Shah's songs)
3. **Bhatiali** - Bengal (river songs)
4. **Jhumur** - Jharkhand
5. **Santhali Music** - Jharkhand

West India

1. **Lok Geet** - Rajasthan
2. **Pabuji Ki Phad** - Rajasthan (scroll singing)
3. **Maand** - Rajasthan (royal court music)
4. **Ghazals** - Gujarat

Northeast India

1. **Bihu** - Assam (harvest songs)
2. **Baul** - Tripura
3. **Nagaland Folk Songs** - Nagaland

Folk Instruments

1. **Sarangi** - North India
2. **Ektara** - Bengal
3. **Dotara** - Bengal
4. **Chimta** - Punjab
5. **Nadaswaram** - South India
6. **Tavil** - Tamil Nadu

15. INDIAN FOLK DANCE

Major Folk Dances of India

North India

Dance	State	Occasion
Bhangra	Punjab	Harvest festival
Giddha	Punjab	Women's folk dance
Dandiya Raas	Gujarat	Navratri
Garba	Gujarat	Navratri
Chhau	West Bengal, Jharkhand, Odisha	Spring festival
Jhora	Uttarakhand	Festivals
Nautanki	Uttar Pradesh	Theatre-dance

South India

Dance	State	Occasion
Theyyam	Kerala	Temple rituals
Padayani	Kerala	Temple festivals
Karakattam	Tamil Nadu	Rain god worship
Mayilattam	Tamil Nadu	Peacock dance
Yakshagana	Karnataka	Epics and myths

East India

Dance	State	Occasion
Chhau	Odisha	Spring festival
Jhumur	Jharkhand	Harvest
Santhali Dance	Jharkhand	Festivals
Bihu	Assam	Harvest

West India

Dance	State	Occasion
Lavani	Maharashtra	Social themes
Tamasha	Maharashtra	Folk theatre
Bhavai	Gujarat	Mythological stories

Northeast India

Dance	State	Occasion
Bihu	Assam	Harvest
Naga Dances	Nagaland	Festivals
Manipuri Dance	Manipur	Religious

Special Folk Dances with UNESCO Recognition

- 1. **Kalbelia** - Rajasthan (UNESCO ICH)
- 2. **Chhau** - West Bengal/Jharkhand/Odisha (UNESCO ICH)
- 3. **Garba** - Gujarat (UNESCO ICH)

16. INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE

Eight Recognized Classical Dances

Dance	State	Origin
Bharatanatyam	Tamil Nadu	Temple dance of Tamil Nadu
Kathak	North India	Mughal courts
Kathakali	Kerala	17th century
Manipuri	Manipur	Religious dance
Kuchipudi	Andhra Pradesh	Temple dance
Odissi	Odisha	Temple dance
Mohiniyattam	Kerala	Lasya tradition
Sattriya	Assam	Sattras (monasteries)

Key Features

Bharatanatyam

- **State:** Tamil Nadu
- **Origin:** Natya Shastra
- **Features:** Hand gestures (mudras), facial expressions
- **Costume:** Colorful silk saree, jewelry

Kathak

- **Region:** North India
- **Origin:** Storytellers (Kathakars)
- **Features:** Intricate footwork, spins (chakkars)

- **Influence:** Mughal courts

Kathakali

- **State:** Kerala
- **Origin:** 17th century
- **Features:** Elaborate makeup, costumes
- **Stories:** Ramayana, Mahabharata

Manipuri

- **State:** Manipur
- **Origin:** Religious dance
- **Features:** Graceful, devotional
- **Stories:** Radha-Krishna

Kuchipudi

- **State:** Andhra Pradesh
- **Origin:** Village of Kuchipudi
- **Features:** Dance-drama tradition
- **Stories:** Mythological

Odissi

- **State:** Odisha
- **Origin:** Temple dance
- **Features:** Sculptural poses
- **Inspiration:** Konark Temple sculptures

Mohiniyattam

- **State:** Kerala

- **Origin:** Lasya tradition
- **Features:** Graceful, feminine
- **Costume:** White and gold

Sattriya

- **State:** Assam
- **Origin:** Sattras (Vaishnavite monasteries)
- **Features:** Devotional
- **Promoter:** Srimanta Sankardev

17. INDIAN CLASSICAL PAINTING

Major Schools of Indian Classical Painting

1. Mughal Painting

- **Period:** 16th-19th century
- **Features:** Miniature paintings, Persian influence
- **Themes:** Court scenes, hunting, portraits
- **Famous Works:** Baburnama, Akbarnama

2. Rajput Painting

- **Period:** 16th-19th century
- **Features:** Bold colors, emotional expressions
- **Schools:** Mewar, Bundi, Kota, Jaipur, Kishangarh
- **Themes:** Radha-Krishna, ragas, seasons

3. Pahari Painting

- **Period:** 17th-19th century
- **Region:** Himalayan foothills
- **Schools:** Kangra, Guler, Basohli
- **Themes:** Krishna leela, nature

4. Deccan Painting

- **Period:** 16th-18th century
- **Region:** Deccan plateau
- **Schools:** Bijapur, Golconda, Ahmadnagar
- **Features:** Persian and European influence

5. Tanjore Painting

- **State:** Tamil Nadu
- **Features:** Gold foil work, 3D effect
- **Themes:** Hindu deities
- **Use:** Temple decoration

6. Mysore Painting

- **State:** Karnataka
- **Features:** Gold leaf work
- **Themes:** Hindu mythology

Key Characteristics of Classical Painting

- **Miniature format**
- **Natural pigments**
- **Intricate details**
- **Mythological themes**
- **Court patronage**

18. INDIAN FOLK PAINTING

Major Folk Painting Traditions

1. Madhubani Painting

- **State:** Bihar
- **Region:** Mithila
- **Features:** Geometric patterns, bright colors
- **Themes:** Nature, mythology, social events
- **Artists:** Women (traditional)
- **GI Tag:** Yes

2. Warli Painting

- **State:** Maharashtra
- **Features:** White pigment on red mud wall
- **Themes:** Daily life, nature, festivals
- **Tribal:** Warli tribe

3. Pattachitra

- **State:** Odisha, West Bengal
- **Features:** Scroll painting
- **Themes:** Jagannath mythology
- **Use:** Temple decoration

4. Phad Painting

- **State:** Rajasthan
- **Features:** Scroll painting

- **Themes:** Folk deities, heroic tales
- **Use:** Narrative singing

5. Gond Painting

- **State:** Madhya Pradesh
- **Features:** Dotted patterns, bright colors
- **Themes:** Nature, mythology
- **Tribal:** Gond tribe

6. Kalighat Painting

- **State:** West Bengal
- **Region:** Kolkata
- **Features:** Bold lines, social commentary
- **Themes:** Daily life, mythology

7. Kolam

- **State:** Tamil Nadu
- **Features:** Geometric patterns
- **Use:** Threshold drawings
- **Occasion:** Daily ritual

8. Rangoli

- **Region:** Pan-India
- **Features:** Colorful patterns
- **Use:** Floor decoration
- **Occasion:** Festivals

9. Pithora Painting

- **State:** Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh
- **Tribal:** Rathwa tribe
- **Features:** Wall painting
- **Themes:** Nature, mythology

10. Lanjia Saura Painting

- **State:** Odisha
- **Tribal:** Saura tribe
- **Features:** Geometric patterns
- **Themes:** Religious

19. INDIAN ARCHITECTURE

Major Architectural Styles

1. Ancient Indian Architecture

Indus Valley Civilization (3300-1300 BCE)

- **Features:** Urban planning, drainage systems
- **Sites:** Mohenjo-daro, Harappa

Vedic Period (1500-500 BCE)

- **Features:** Temple architecture beginnings
- **Texts:** Vastu Shastra

2. Temple Architecture

Nagara Style (North India)

- **Features:** Curvilinear shikhara
- **Examples:** Khajuraho, Konark

Dravidian Style (South India)

- **Features:** Pyramidal vimana, gopurams
- **Examples:** Meenakshi Temple, Brihadeshwara

Vesara Style (Deccan)

- **Features:** Mix of Nagara and Dravidian
- **Examples:** Hoysala temples

3. Indo-Islamic Architecture

Delhi Sultanate (1206-1526)

- **Features:** Arches, domes, minarets
- **Examples:** Qutub Minar, Alai Darwaza

Mughal Architecture (1526-1857)

- **Features:** Symmetry, gardens, pietra dura
- **Examples:** Taj Mahal, Red Fort, Fatehpur Sikri

Provincial Styles

- **Bengal:** Terracotta temples
- **Gujarat:** Stepwells, mosques
- **Deccan:** Golconda Fort

4. Colonial Architecture

Portuguese

- **Region:** Goa
- **Examples:** Basilica of Bom Jesus

British

- **Style:** Neo-Gothic, Indo-Saracenic
- **Examples:** Victoria Terminus, Gateway of India

5. Modern Architecture

Post-Independence

- **Architects:** Charles Correa, B.V. Doshi
- **Features:** Modernist with Indian elements

- **Examples:** Chandigarh (Le Corbusier)

Key Monuments

Monument	Location	Style
Taj Mahal	Agra	Mughal
Qutub Minar	Delhi	Indo-Islamic
Konark Temple	Odisha	Nagara
Brihadeshwara	Tamil Nadu	Dravidian
Hampi	Karnataka	Vijayanagara
Khajuraho	MP	Nagara
Ajanta-Ellora	Maharashtra	Rock-cut
Gateway of India	Mumbai	Indo-Saracenic

SUMMARY & KEY TAKEAWAYS

For Competitive Exams (UPSC, SSC, FTII)

Must-Know Facts

1. **UNESCO ICH India:** 16 elements (latest: Deepavali 2025)
2. **First Indian Oscar:** Bhanu Athaiya (1983, Gandhi)
3. **First Indian Feature Film:** Raja Harishchandra (1913)
4. **First GI Tag:** Darjeeling Tea (2004)
5. **Doordarshan Started:** September 15, 1959
6. **First Colour TV:** August 15, 1982
7. **Chhayawad Period:** 1918-1936
8. **8 Classical Dances:** Bharatanatyam, Kathak, Kathakali, Manipuri, Kuchipudi, Odissi, Mohiniyattam, Sattriya

Recent Awards (2025-2026)

- **Oscars 2026:** One Battle After Another (Best Picture)
- **Cannes 2026:** Fjord (Palme d'Or)
- **Booker 2026:** Taiwan Travelogue
- **Nobel 2025:** Krasznahorkai (Literature)
- **National Film Awards 2025:** 12th Fail (Best Film)

GI Tags Recent

- **658+ GI-tagged products** in India
- **Target:** 10,000 by 2030
- **Recent:** Assam, Jharkhand, Tripura additions

Compiled by Guru Bob

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